

Topic 2.2 – Global Connections

“As the world becomes more interdependent, global governance, including global economic governance and the governance of the global commons, is increasingly relevant for achieving sustainable development.” – United Nations System Task Team

This topic allows learners to explore the processes and flows that occur at the global level, and the ways in which these influence people, places and institutions. Through **two** overarching themes of global systems and global governance learners will investigate how these shape relationships between citizens, states and organisations around the world.

Global systems, including those that regulate and order trade, financial transactions and migration, create interdependencies, which produce uneven geographies of winners and losers. States and non-state organisations respond to these flows and global systems, which can sometimes act to promote stability, growth and development,

but which can also be the cause of inequalities, conflicts and injustice.

Through case studies learners will build up a picture of how the world around them is shaped, the complexities associated with this and the resulting issues for people. Study will include the use of both quantitative and qualitative approaches across the global systems and global governance themes as a whole.

Study must enable learners to gain an understanding of the way in which global systems and global governance underlie their own and other people’s lives across the globe. This understanding will vary depending on the situation and circumstance of the learner; fieldwork and research is encouraged where possible in support of this.

Learners must choose **one** of **Option A or B** within their study of Global Systems and **one** of **Options C or D** for their study of Global Governance.

2.2.1 Global Systems: Option A – Trade in the Contemporary World

1. What are the contemporary patterns of international trade?	
Key Ideas	Content
1.a. International trade involves flows of merchandise, services and capital which vary spatially.	• An understanding of the terms merchandise, services and capital as components of international trade. • Current spatial patterns in the direction and components of international trade, including examples of both inter-regional and intra-regional.
1.b. Current patterns of international trade are related to global patterns of socio-economic development.	• The relationship between patterns of international trade and socio-economic development using national indices, such as ‘value of exports’ and ‘Human Development Index’. • How international trade can promote stability, growth and development within and between countries, through flows of people, money, ideas and technology. • How international trade causes inequalities, conflicts and injustices for people and places, through flows of people, money, ideas and technology.

2. Why has trade become increasingly complex?

Key Ideas	Content
2.a. Access to markets are influenced by a multitude of inter-related factors.	• International trade has increased connectivity due to changes in the 21st century, including: ◦ technology, transport and communications have increased connectivity of global supply chains ◦ increasing influence of MNCs in EDCs, including outsourcing ◦ role of regional trading blocs, such as the EU ◦ growth of 'south-south' trade, between developing countries ◦ growth of services in the global economy ◦ increasing labour mobility and new international division of labour.
2.b. There is interdependence between countries and their trading partners.	• Case study of one EDC to illustrate: ◦ direction and components of its current international trade patterns ◦ changes in its international trade patterns over time ◦ economic, political, social and environmental interdependence with trading partners ◦ impacts of trade on the EDC, including economic development, political stability and social equality.

3. What are the issues associated with unequal flows of international trade?

Key Ideas	Content
3.a. International trade creates opportunities and challenges which reflect unequal power relations between countries.	• Case study of one AC to show how core economies have a strong influence and drive change in the global trade system to their own advantage. Illustrate through economic, political and social factors to explain: ◦ its advantages for trade, including patterns, partners, negotiations and agreements ◦ opportunities, such as sustained economic growth ◦ challenges, such as trade deficit. • Case study of one LIDC to show how peripheral economies exert limited influence and can only respond to change in the global trade system. Illustrate this through economic, political and social factors to explain: ◦ trade components, including patterns, partners, negotiations and agreements ◦ why it has limited access to global markets ◦ opportunities, such as diversification of economic activity ◦ challenges, such as political instability.

2.2.2 Global Systems: Option B – Global Migration

1. What are the contemporary patterns of global migration?	
Key Ideas	Content
1.a. Global migration involves dynamic flows of people between countries, regions and continents.	• Current spatial patterns in the numbers, composition and direction of international migrant flows, including examples of both inter-regional and intra-regional.
1.b. Current patterns of international migration are related to global patterns of socio-economic development.	• The relationship between patterns of international migration and socio-economic development, using national indices such as 'value of migrant remittances' and 'Human Development Index'. • How global migration can promote stability, growth and development within and between countries through flows of people, money, ideas and technology. • How global migration causes inequalities, conflicts and injustices for people and places through flows of people, money, ideas and technology.

2. Why has migration become increasingly complex?	
Key Ideas	Content
2.a. Global migration patterns are influenced by a multitude of inter-related factors.	• Changes in the 21st century have increased the complexity of global migration, including: ◦ economic globalisation leading to the emergence of new source areas and host destinations ◦ high concentration of young workers and female migrants ◦ flows in South-South corridors are now equal in magnitude to those in South-North corridors ◦ conflict and persecution have increased numbers of refugees ◦ changes in national immigration and emigration policies ◦ development of distinct corridors of bi-lateral flows.
2.b. Corridors of migrant flows create interdependence between countries.	• Case study of one EDC to illustrate: ◦ current patterns of immigration and emigration ◦ changes in immigration and emigration over time ◦ economic, political, social and environmental interdependence with countries connected to the EDC by migrant flows ◦ the impact of migration on the EDCs economic development, political stability and social equality.

3. What are the issues associated with unequal flows of global migration?

Key Ideas	Content
3.a. Global migration creates opportunities and challenges which reflect the unequal power relations between countries.	• Case study of one AC to show how it influences and drives change in the global migration system. Illustrate economic, political and social factors which explain: ◦ patterns of emigration and immigration, migration policies, and interdependence with countries linked to it by migration ◦ opportunities, such as labour supply ◦ challenges, such as border issues. • Case study of one LIDC to show how it has limited influence over and restricted response to the global migration system. Illustrate economic, political and social factors which explain: ◦ patterns of emigration and immigration, migration policies, and interdependence with countries linked to it by migration ◦ opportunities, such as migrant remittances ◦ challenges, such as loss of skilled workers.

2.2.3 Global Governance: Option C – Human Rights

1. What is meant by human rights?	
Key Ideas	Content
1.a. There is global variation in human rights norms.	• Understanding of what is meant by human rights. • Understand the terms of norms, intervention and geopolitics and how they are fundamental in appreciating that human rights are complex issues.
1.b. Patterns of human rights violations are influenced by a range of factors.	• Current spatial patterns of human rights issues, including forced labour, maternal mortality rates and capital punishment. • Factors that influence global variations of forced labour, maternal mortality rates and capital punishment.

2. What are the variations in women's rights?	
Key Ideas	Content
2.a. The geography of gender inequality is complex and contested.	• Economic, political and social factors to explain variation in the patterns of gender inequality, including the challenges of educational opportunity, access to reproductive health services and employment opportunity. • Case study of women's rights in a country to illustrate: ◦ the gender inequality issues that are apparent in that country ◦ the consequences of gender inequality on society ◦ evidence of changing norms and strategies to address gender inequality issues.

3. What are the strategies for global governance of human rights?	
Key Ideas	Content
3.a. Human rights violations can be a cause and consequence of conflict.	• How the violation of human rights can be a cause of conflict, such as access to education and discrimination. • How the violation of human rights can be a consequence of conflict and how this can be addressed through geopolitical intervention. • The role of flows of people, money, ideas and technology in geopolitical intervention.
3.b. Global governance of human rights involves cooperation between organisations at scales from global to local, often in partnership.	• How human rights are promoted and protected by institutions, treaties, laws and norms. • Case study of strategies for global governance of human rights in one area of conflict to illustrate: ◦ contributions and interactions of different organisations at a range of scales from global to local, including the United Nations, a national government and an NGO ◦ consequences of global governance of human rights for local communities.

4. To what extent has intervention in human rights contributed to development?

Key Ideas	Content
4.a. Global governance of human rights has consequences for citizens and places.	• How the global governance of human rights issues has consequences for citizens and places, including short term effects, such as immediate relief from NGOs, and longer term effects, such as changes in laws. • Case study of the impact of global governance of human rights in an LIDC, including: ◦ the human rights issue/issues ◦ the global governance strategy/strategies used ◦ opportunities for stability, growth and development ◦ challenges of inequality and injustice.

2.2.4 Global Governance: Option D – Power and Borders

1. What is meant by sovereignty and territorial integrity?

Key Ideas	Content
1.a. The world political map of sovereign nation-states is dynamic.	• Definitions of state, nation, sovereignty and territorial integrity and how they are fundamental in understanding the world political map. • Understand the terms of norms, intervention and geopolitics and how they are fundamental in appreciating that sovereignty and territorial integrity are complex issues.

2. What are the contemporary challenges to sovereign state authority?

Key Ideas	Content
2.a. A multitude of factors pose challenges to sovereignty and territorial integrity.	• Erosion of sovereignty and loss of territorial integrity are influenced by economic, political, social and environmental factors, including the challenges of: ◦ current political boundaries ◦ transnational corporations (TNCs) ◦ supranational institutions such as regional trading blocs ◦ political dominance of ethnic groups. • Case study of one country in which sovereignty has been challenged, including: ◦ causes and challenges to the government ◦ impacts on people and places.

3. What is the role of global governance in conflict?

Key Ideas	Content
3.a. Global governance provides a framework to regulate the challenge of conflict.	• How challenges to sovereignty and territorial integrity can be a cause of conflict, such as access to natural resources. • The role of institutions, treaties, laws and norms which are significant in regulating conflict and in reproducing the global system of sovereign nation-states. • The role of flows of people, money, ideas and technology in geopolitical intervention.
3.b. Global governance involves cooperation between organisations at scales from global to local, often in partnership.	• Case study of strategies for global governance in one area of conflict to illustrate: ◦ interventions and interactions of organisations at a range of scales, including the United Nations, a national government and an NGO ◦ consequences of global governance of the conflict for local communities.

4. How effective is global governance of sovereignty and territorial integrity?

Key Ideas	Content
4.a. Global governance of sovereignty and territorial integrity has consequences for citizens and places.	• How the global governance of sovereignty issues has consequences for citizens and places, including short term effects, such as humanitarian aid, and longer term effects, such as changes in political regime. • How the global governance of territorial integrity issues has consequences for citizens and places, including short term effects, such as maintaining peace, and longer term effects, such as trade relationships. • Case study of the impact of global governance of sovereignty or territorial integrity in one LIDC to illustrate and explain: ◦ the sovereignty or territorial integrity issue/issues ◦ the global governance strategy/strategies used ◦ opportunities for stability, growth and development ◦ challenges of inequality and injustices.